

# ART, B.F.A.

## Overview

<https://www.design.iastate.edu/academics/departments/art-visual-culture/>

The Department of Art and Visual Culture offers degree programs focused on fine arts and visual culture, including the Bachelor of Arts (B.A.) in Art, Bachelor of Arts (B.A.) in Art History, Bachelor of Fine Arts (B.F.A.) in Art, and Master of Fine Arts (M.F.A.) in Integrated Visual Arts. Course offerings include studio arts, art history, art education, and scientific illustration and visualization.

### *B.F.A. in Art*

The Bachelor of Fine Arts in Art (formerly Integrated Studio Arts) is an enrollment-managed, four-year program for students seeking an immersive degree in studio arts with an emphasis on crossing conceptual and media boundaries. In their sophomore year, students complete rotations in our eight media areas: ceramics, textiles, jewelry and metalsmithing, furniture design and woodworking, painting, printmaking, digital media, and photography. Classes in color theory and drawing round out the year.

Junior and senior-level studios provide focused investigation in specific media areas and help prepare students for professional practice and/or graduate study toward a Master of Fine Arts (M.F.A.) degree. Art history courses enhance the studio environment by providing a strong context as students develop their ideas and technical abilities.

Over their four-year course of study, students develop a portfolio and prepare for a professional practice in the visual arts. This concentration engages aesthetics, conceptual development and visual problem-solving, critical thinking, and technical-skill development, using historical and cultural theory, contemporary trends, and studio practice. The B.F.A. degree culminates in a professional exhibition in the College of Design's Gallery 181.

Transfer students with studio credits from other colleges and universities may present a portfolio of work created in those courses to determine if these credits can be applied toward specific studio requirements. Students will present this portfolio upon admission and prior to registration for classes. Arrangements for this process should be made with the department's academic advisors.

The department offers an undergraduate minor in Illustration and participates in the undergraduate minors in Classical Studies, Critical Studies in Design, Design Studies, Digital Media, and Textile Design

## Student Learning Outcomes

Students will:

- Develop traditional and innovating technical skills and artmaking practices;
- Foster conceptual development and creative problem-solving abilities through design, research, and creative processes;
- Understand and express in multiple media the relationship between objects, aesthetics, and meaning;
- Exhibit an awareness of their roles as artists and thinkers regarding the ethical, cultural, and ecological impacts of what they do;
- Express through visual verbal, and written means an awareness of global art movements and a meaningful understanding of historic and contemporary art;
- Use their understanding and practice of art to engage with local, national, and global communities where they can participate in a broad exchange of ideas;
- Prepare for careers in the visual arts through professional development seminars, internships, study abroad, and service-learning opportunities.

## Degree Requirements

The curriculum in leads to a 128 credit undergraduate Bachelor of Fine Arts in Art. Admission into the program requires the completion of at least 31.0 credits, including the following courses: DSNS 1020, DSNS 1100 or 1150, DSNS 1310, DSNS 1320, and DSNS 1830; 6 credits of Social Sciences/Humanities; 6 credits of Math/Science; ENGL 1500 (or test-out credit); LIB 1600. Information on admission criteria is posted each year on the College of Design website.

### Total Degree Requirement: 128 cr.

Only 65 credits from a two-year institution can apply and may include up to 16 technical credits; 9 P-NP credits of free electives; 2.00 minimum GPA.

### International Perspective: 3 credits

### U.S. Cultures and Communities: 3 credits

### Communication: 10 credits

(C or better grade ENGL 1500 and ENGL 2500)

|                                |                                                   |   |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|---|
| ENGL 1500                      | Critical Thinking and Communication               | 3 |
| ENGL 2500                      | Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition | 3 |
| LIB 1600                       | Introduction to College Level Research            | 1 |
| One course from the following: |                                                   | 3 |
| COMST 1010                     | Introduction to Communication Studies             |   |
| COMST 2110                     | Interpersonal Communication                       |   |
| SPCM 2120                      | Fundamentals of Public Speaking                   |   |

**Total Credits** **10**

### Humanities: 6 credits

6 credits from College of Design General Education Approved Course list.

**Social Sciences: 6 credits**

6 credits from College of Design General Education Approved Course list.

**Math/Physics/Biol. Sciences: 6 credits**

6 credits from College of Design General Education Approved Course list.

**General Education Courses: 9 credits**

6 credits at level 3000-4000 from College of Design General Education Approved Course List

3 credits from College of Design General Education Approved Course list

**Total Credits 9****College of Design Core: 13 credits**

DSNS 1020 Design Studio I 4

DSNS 1150 Design Collaborative Seminar 1  
or DSNS 1100 Design Exchange Seminar I

DSNS 1310 Drawing I 4

DSNS 1320 Digital Design Literacy 1

DSNS 1830 Design in Context 3

**Total Credits 13****ART Core: 31 credits**

ART 2020 Studio Fundamentals: Wood 2

ART 2030 Studio Fundamentals: Jewelry/Metals 2

ART 2040 Studio Fundamentals: Ceramics 2

ART 2060 Studio Fundamentals: Printmaking 2

ART 2080 Color 2

ART 2100 Studio Fundamentals: Photo 2

ART 2120 Studio Fundamentals: Digital Media 3

ART 2130 Studio Fundamentals: Painting 2

ART 2140 Studio Fundamentals: Textiles 2

ART 2300 Drawing II 3

ART 3100 Sources and Methods of Visual Art 3

ARTH 2800 History of Art I 3

ARTH 2810 History of Art II 3

**Total Credits 31****ART Concentration: 24 credits**

Eight courses from ART studio offerings. Faculty advisors will assist students in developing their studio concentration plan.

**Art History: 9 credits**

At least 6 credits from ARTH 3000+ course level.

**Professional Practice: 3 credits**

ART 3990 Professional Practice for Visual Artists 2

ART 4990 BFA/BA Exhibition 1

**Total Credits 3****Electives: 11 credits**

DSNS 3010 Rome Predeparture (Rome option only)

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**First Year**

| Fall                             | Credits Spring                     | Credits   |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------|-----------|
| DSNS 1020 or 1310                | 4 DSNS 1020 or 1310                | 4         |
| DSNS 1100 or 1150                | 1 DSNS 1830 (or General Education) | 3         |
| DSNS 1320                        | 1 ENGL 1500 (or General Education) | 3         |
| DSNS 1830 (or General Education) | 3 General Education                | 3         |
| ENGL 1500 (or General Education) | 3 General Education                | 3         |
| General Education                | 3 LIB 1600                         | 1         |
| General Education                | 3                                  |           |
|                                  | <b>18</b>                          | <b>17</b> |

**Second Year**

| Fall                             | Credits Spring                     | Credits   |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------|-----------|
| ARTH 2800 (fall only)            | 3 ARTH 2810 (spring only)          | 3         |
| ART 2120 or 2300                 | 3 ART 2300 or 2120                 | 3         |
| ART Studio Fundamentals          | 2 ART Studio Fundamentals          | 2         |
| ART Studio Fundamentals          | 2 ART Studio Fundamentals          | 2         |
| ART Studio Fundamentals          | 2 ART Studio Fundamentals          | 2         |
| ART Studio Fundamentals          | 2 ART Studio Fundamentals          | 2         |
| ENGL 2500 (or General Education) | 3 ENGL 2500 (or General Education) | 3         |
|                                  | <b>17</b>                          | <b>17</b> |

**Third Year**

| Fall                     | Credits Spring               | Credits   |
|--------------------------|------------------------------|-----------|
| ART 3100                 | 3 ART Studio Option          | 3         |
| ART Studio Option        | 3 ART Studio Option          | 3         |
| ART Studio Option        | 3 ART Studio Option          | 3         |
| ARTH 3000 level or above | 3 ARTH 3000 level or above   | 3         |
| General Education        | 3 ART 3990                   | 2         |
|                          | DSNS 3010 (Rome option only) | 1         |
|                          | <b>15</b>                    | <b>15</b> |

**Fourth Year**

| <b>Fall</b>                   | <b>Credits Spring</b> | <b>Credits</b> |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------|
| ART Studio Option             | 3 ART Studio Option   | 3              |
| ART Studio Option             | 3 ART Studio Option   | 3              |
| ARTH 3000 level or above      | 3 ART 4990            | 1              |
| General Education or Elective | 3 General Education   | 3              |
| Elective                      | 3 Elective            | 5              |
| <b>15</b>                     |                       | <b>15</b>      |

## Post-Baccalaureate Undergraduate Certificate

Iowa State's Post-Baccalaureate Undergraduate Certificate program in Art prepares students for graduate study or career advancements by providing a focused environment for deepening aesthetic, technical, creative, and conceptual skills. While a bachelor's degree in visual or fine arts is not necessary, a strong portfolio of creative work and a written statement of purpose are required for admission.

### Curriculum

Post-baccalaureate students will work with a faculty advisor to create a tailored 25-credit program of study including:

- 15 credits of 3000/4000-level art courses (ART);
- Six (6) credits of 3000/4000-level art history courses (ARTH);
- Three-credit elective selected from a list of options;
- ART 4910: One-credit capstone exhibition course.

For the capstone experience, you will be expected to produce an artist's statement and a written assessment of your learning that will be reviewed, along with your art, by the faculty.

This certificate program must be completed within two years. Students interested in developing a body of work for admission to graduate school or to focus on further skill development prior to moving into professional practice will be ideal candidates.

### Application Requirements

To apply for this program, please submit the following materials.

1. Digital portfolio:
  - Twenty (20) images of recent work with no more than four (4) of the images being details.
  - Descriptions on each image need to include title, date, size and medium
2. One-page statement of intent.
3. Current resume or CV.
4. Name and contact information of three (3) references.

## Graduate Program

The Master of Fine Arts (MFA) in Integrated Visual Arts (IVA) graduate program is committed to the professional development of artists and arts innovators. It offers unique opportunities for collaboration with students and faculty from around the world in art and design programs that represent a wide spectrum of professional activities.

The 63-credit Master of Fine Arts in Integrated Visual Arts at Iowa State University is a unique interdisciplinary program offering study in media areas including ceramics, digital media, drawing, textiles, illustration, jewelry/metalsmithing, painting, printmaking, photography, and woods/furniture design. The Integrated Visual Arts program offers an innovative curriculum aligned with emerging art and design markets.

### Learning Goals

Students will:

- Develop a fully realized creative direction that provides a platform for continued professional research and visual expression.
- Produce a body of work that demonstrates a high level of creative investigation and accomplishment.
- Acquire a professional level of technical proficiency in one or more media areas.
- Effectively communicate ideas verbally and in writing.
- Know the current and historical contexts within which their creative pursuits exist.
- Develop a well-formed personal creative philosophy.
- Understand current ethical and social issues relevant to the visual arts.
- Use relevant theory in pursuing creative university level scholarship.
- Understand the structure and organization required for university-level art instruction.

### Application Deadlines:

Please submit your application and supporting materials by January 15 for fall admission and November 1 for spring admission. Applications received after these dates may be considered for program admission, but applicants may have fewer assistantship options.

### Studio Courses: 39 credits

|                               |    |
|-------------------------------|----|
| Courses numbered ART          | 27 |
| Studio Courses outside of ART | 6  |
| ART 6990A and ART 6990B       | 6  |

### Seminar Courses: 6 credits

(Students take 2 sections of ART 5710, or 1 section of ART 5710 and ART 5110)

|                           |                                                 |         |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Graduate Seminar ART 5710 |                                                 | 3       |
|                           |                                                 | credits |
|                           |                                                 | each    |
|                           |                                                 | section |
| ART 5710                  | Graduate Seminar: Professional Practice         |         |
| ART 5720                  | Graduate Seminar: Critique and Creative Process |         |
| ART 5110                  | Seminar in Studio Arts Teaching                 |         |

**Art History/Theory/Criticism: 12 credits**

|                     |  |   |
|---------------------|--|---|
| ARTH 5010 required  |  | 3 |
| Art History courses |  | 9 |

**Related Courses (outside of IVA program): 3 credits**  
**Total: 60 Credits**